

Workplace Conduct and POSH (Prevention of Sexual Harassment) Policy

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Version: 4.1

Effective Date: June 1, 2024

Policy Owner: Employee Relations & Legal Compliance

Classification: Internal / Public (Employees)

1. Purpose and Objective

The Company is committed to providing a safe, respectful, and inclusive work environment free from discrimination, bullying, and harassment. This policy establishes the Code of Conduct and outlines the strict mechanisms for the Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH), ensuring a zero-tolerance approach to any violations.

2. Scope and Applicability

This policy applies to all individuals associated with the Company, including full-time employees, contractors, consultants, interns, vendors, and visitors. It covers conduct within the physical workplace, during remote work (virtual meetings, digital communications), at off-site company events, and during corporate travel.

3. Core Principles of Workplace Conduct

All employees are expected to:

- Treat colleagues, clients, and partners with dignity and professional respect.
- Maintain a workplace free from derogatory comments, slurs, or exclusionary behavior based on race, gender, religion, age, disability, or sexual orientation.
- Refrain from any form of physical violence, intimidation, or aggressive verbal conduct.

4. Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) Framework

4.1 Definition of Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment includes any unwelcome sexually determined behavior (whether direct or by implication), such as:

- Physical contact and advances.
- A demand or request for sexual favors.
- Sexually colored remarks, inappropriate jokes, or intrusive questions about personal life.
- Showing pornography or transmitting explicit digital content.
- Any other unwelcome physical, verbal, or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature.

4.2 The Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)

The Company has constituted an Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) to address all POSH-related grievances impartially and confidentially.

- **Composition:** The ICC is led by a senior female executive (Presiding Officer) and includes at least two internal employee representatives and one external, independent legal/NGO member.
- **Tenure:** ICC members serve a term not exceeding three (3) years.

4.3 Filing a POSH Complaint

- An aggrieved individual may submit a written complaint to the ICC via the dedicated, secure portal or directly to icc-confidential@company.com within **90 days** from the date of the incident.
- The ICC is obligated to initiate an inquiry within **7 business days** of receiving a formal complaint.

5. Whistleblower & General Grievance Reporting

For non-POSH code of conduct violations (e.g., bullying, financial fraud, ethics violations), employees must use the Whistleblower mechanism.

- Reports can be filed anonymously through the Ethics Hotline (1-800-555-9990) or via email to ethics@company.com.
- **Non-Retaliation Clause:** The Company strictly prohibits any form of retaliation, demotion, or victimization against an employee who reports a concern in good faith.

6. Disciplinary Actions

Violations of this policy will result in swift disciplinary action, which may include, but is not limited to:

- Written warning and mandatory behavioral counseling.
- Suspension without pay.
- Immediate termination of employment for gross misconduct.
- **Malicious Complaints:** If the ICC or Ethics Board determines that a complaint was intentionally false or forged, disciplinary action will be taken against the complainant.

7. Points of Contact

- **POSH / Internal Complaints Committee (Strictly Confidential):** icc-confidential@company.com
- **General Ethics & Code of Conduct:** ethics@company.com
- **Legal Inquiries:** Samantha Wheeler, VP Legal & Compliance.

8. Amendment History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
2.0	Aug 15, 2020	Employee Relations	Integrated remote work and virtual meeting guidelines into conduct scope.
3.0	Jan 10, 2022	Samantha Wheeler	Reconstituted the ICC and added the external NGO member requirement.
4.0	Nov 01, 2023	Employee Relations	Added the non-retaliation whistleblower clause.
4.1	May 25, 2024	Samantha Wheeler	Updated the complaint filing window to exactly 90 days.

9. Authorizations and Signatures

Prepared By:

Employee Relations Committee

Date: May 20, 2024

Reviewed By:

Samantha Wheeler

VP, Legal & Compliance

Date: May 25, 2024

Approved By:

Dr. Angela Vance

Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO)

Date: May 28, 2024